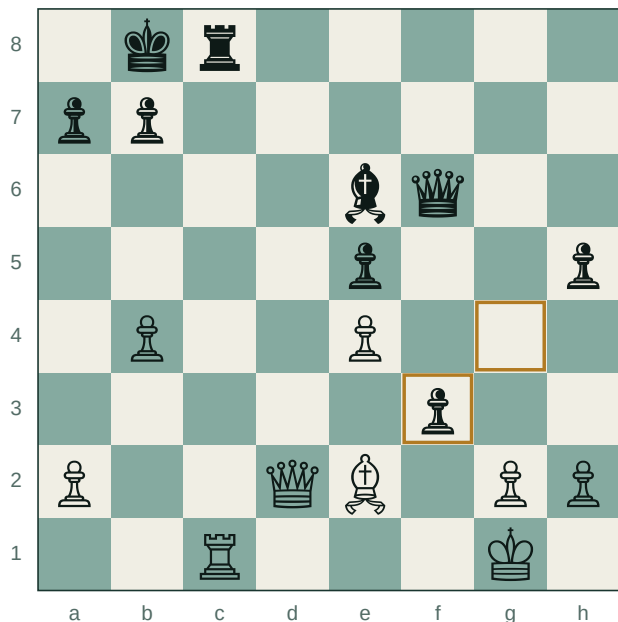


Deflection tactics: White, move 28

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 27...gxf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28. Qd6+ Ka8 29. Rxc8+ Bxc8 30. Qxf6

28.Qd6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d6 it attacks king on b8 and bishop on e6. Recorded reply: **28...Ka8**.

29.Rxc8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on c8. Recorded reply: **29...Bxc8**.

30.Qxf6 The queen captures the queen on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from +0 to +9. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: queen on f6. Check for tactical protection.